

Five Signs Your Sales Team Is Not Reaching the Market You Think It Is

Why distributor coverage is not market coverage, and what changes when the field works from one daily list.

5
warning signs

10-point
scorecard

10 min
read

WHY THIS GUIDE

Most manufacturers don't have a coverage problem on paper. They have a reach problem.

Distributor expansion looks good on the map. Every district has a distributor, every distributor has a target, and primary billing says the network is working. Below the distributor, the picture changes: the shops, retailers and project customers who actually buy are largely invisible to you.

The same pattern shows up everywhere. Half the counters below the distributor never see your team. Billing lands in the last week of the month. Beat plans are complete; productive visits are not.

This guide covers five warning signs that reach, not product or price, is the constraint, and what changes when the field works from one daily list.

Contents

01 Half the counters are invisible 3

02 Billing lands in the last week 4

03 Visits are logged, orders are not 5

04 Pipeline stops at the regional head 6

05 Reporting crowds out selling 7

What changes with one daily list 8

Scorecard and next steps 9

01 SIGN ONE

You can't see half the counters in your channel

If 40 to 50% of the end customers below your distributors are invisible to you, your share there is a guess.

What it looks like

- Secondary sales arrive late, partial or not at all.
- You know your distributors, not their retailers.
- New outlets get added, but dormant ones are never noticed.
- Market potential by territory is not known, so targets are set on last year's billing.

What it costs

You plan on primary billing while share is won or lost at counters you cannot see. A competitor can take a whole market below your distributor before it shows up in your numbers.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

A dealer and distributor system captures secondary sales outlet by outlet. Every counter below the distributor becomes visible, dormant outlets show up the week they go quiet, and every territory gets a coverage number the team works against.

02 SIGN TWO

Most of the month's billing lands in the last week

If three quiet weeks are followed by one frantic one, the month is being closed by schemes, not built by demand.

What it looks like

- The first three weeks are slow, and the last week is a scramble.
- Schemes and discounts are used to close the gap.
- Distributors load stock to meet targets, then sit on it.
- The plant sees spikes it cannot plan for.

What it costs

Margin is given away at month-end. Channels are stuffed with stock that sells slowly next month, and the plant runs on a sawtooth of idle weeks and overtime.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

Daily order flow is tracked against the month, so a slow week shows up while there is still time to act. WhatsApp ordering lets the channel order the day it needs stock. Revenue builds through the month instead of arriving in one week.

03 SIGN THREE

Beat plans look complete, productive visits do not

If every outlet on the beat is ticked but few visits end in an order, the field is busy, not productive.

What it looks like

- Visits are logged, but few end in an order.
- Reps visit the same comfortable outlets week after week.
- Managers see the day's work only in the evening report.
- Visit quality is never measured, only the number of visits.

What it costs

A full field team produces a fraction of its potential. Salaries, travel and fuel are spent in full every month. The orders are not.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

Multiple AI agents brief the rep before each visit: last order, open issues, scheme exposure. After the visit, they suggest the next-best action. Managers see visit quality the same day, not in the evening report.

04 SIGN FOUR

Pipeline visibility ends at the regional head

If project and institutional deals are known only to the people chasing them, leadership is steering on trust.

What it looks like

- Project and institutional leads live in personal phones and spreadsheets.
- Win rates are not known by segment or region.
- Leadership sees a forecast, not the deals behind it.
- Lost deals are never analysed, so the same losses repeat.

What it costs

Decisions on targets and territories are made without the numbers. When a regional head leaves, the pipeline often leaves with them.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

A CRM and a field sales app run on one system, so every lead, visit and order rolls up to a live view by segment and region. Leadership can question it in plain language: which projects stalled this month, and why.

05 SIGN FIVE

Your field team spends hours on reporting, not selling

If reps end every day typing up what they did, that time comes straight out of selling.

What it looks like

- Orders are taken on paper or WhatsApp, then re-keyed.
- Expense and visit reports eat the end of every day.
- Product, price and scheme information is out of date in the field.
- New reps take months to become productive.

What it costs

Selling time is lost every day, multiplied across the whole team. Orders arrive late or wrong, and the reports managers read are already a day old.

CLIENT EXAMPLE

Silver Consumer Electricals, a consumer durables maker with four divisions: we ran channel loyalty, field sales and sales management across all four divisions on one owned platform. **15,000+ active retailers; sales added: +Rs 100 Cr.**

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

One mobile-first app for orders, visits and reports, with the ERP behind it. Orders go straight in, reports build from the day's activity, and price and scheme data stays current. The rep sells; the system records.

THE ALTERNATIVE

What changes when the field works from one daily list

Distributor coverage tells you where your stock goes. Reach tells you who buys it. The difference shows up in six places.

	Reach today	Reach on RARE OS
Who you can see	Distributors	Every outlet below them
Secondary sales	Late, partial or missing	Captured outlet by outlet
Field day	Beat plan and evening report	Pre-visit brief and next-best action
Month-end	Most billing in the last week	Revenue built through the month
Pipeline	In personal phones	One live view, by segment
Channel ordering	Calls and paper	WhatsApp ordering, into the ERP

What a rep sees before a visit

Illustrative only.

Visit: [Outlet name] · Tomorrow 10:00

Last order: 18 days ago

Open issue: invoice dispute

Suggested: place 2 range SKUs the outlet does not carry

It sits on top of your ERP. It is called RARE OS, an operating system for moving market share. Most companies start with one region.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Scorecard: where do you stand?

Tick each statement that is true for your business today.

- [ ] 01 We cannot see secondary sales for most outlets.
- [ ] 02 We know our distributors, not their retailers.
- [ ] 03 Most monthly billing lands in the last week.
- [ ] 04 Schemes are used to close month-end gaps.
- [ ] 05 Few logged visits end in an order.
- [ ] 06 Managers see field activity only in the evening.
- [ ] 07 Win rates by region or segment are not known.
- [ ] 08 Leads live in reps' phones and spreadsheets.
- [ ] 09 Orders are re-keyed from paper or WhatsApp.
- [ ] 10 New reps take months to become productive.

0–2 ticks

Your reach is in good shape. Review outlet coverage each quarter.

3–5 ticks

Counters are slipping past your team. One region will show where.

6 or more

Reach is now the constraint on your market share.

NEXT STEPS

Start with one region, prove it, then scale

1. **Pick one region**
   Choose one where distributor billing looks fine but share does not move.

2. **Map outlets you bill against outlets in the market**
   See which counters buy from you, which buy elsewhere and which no one visits.

3. **Run the field on one daily list for a quarter**
   Every rep works from one list: who to visit, what to raise, what to place.

4. **Measure, then scale**
   Track active outlets and month-end share of billing. Extend to the next region once both move.

Scored 3 or more? Get a free reach health check.

In 30 minutes, we review your scorecard and show you which counters your team is missing and where one region would show results fastest. Built for you, owned by you. No obligation.

BOOK
calendly.com/anadi-greymetre/30min

EMAIL
anadi@greymetre.com

CALL
+91 91316 78419

© 2026